

Herman Suykerbuyk

Business Data Engineer | Platform Engineer | Data Infrastructure | ETL & Pipelines

3-5 years experience

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ABOUT ME

I am a Business Data Engineer with 3-5 years of experience across data engineering and platform engineering.

Data Engineering: Two years building end-to-end data transformations - from ingestion pipelines to Data Vault and dimensional modelling.

Platform Engineering: Two years building a new platform on Airflow, dbt and Databricks - enabling faster delivery through reliable pipelines, reusable tooling, test automation and CI/CD.

Leadership: Improved how teams work: reducing unnecessary meetings, consolidating documentation, strengthening refinement sessions, challenging unsuitable frameworks, introducing future-proof solutions and Communities of Practice (COP).

Location

Based in Mechelen, Belgium - open to hybrid/remote. Willing to commute within region.

Current Circumstances

Business Data Engineer, currently working as Platform Engineer. Open to new opportunities.

Languages

Dutch (native), English (professional), French (basic)

Work Preferences

Interested in both technical depth and people leadership.

TOOLSTACK

Languages

Python SQL PL/SQL Groovy Shell Terraform

Data & Transformation

ODI dbt Data Vault 2.0 Dimensional Modelling Vaultspeed

Orchestration & Platform

Apache Airflow IWS Databricks Oracle Lakeflow Connect AKS Azure

Engineering Practices

pytest GitHub Actions CI/CD Confluence JDBC

EXPERIENCE

Data Engineering

ETL / ELT

● Pipeline Development:

I built and maintained end-to-end ETL pipelines: ODI (Oracle) and dbt for transformations, and IWS and Apache Airflow for orchestration. Made ways to speed up the development phase (PL/SQL scripts that generate production release script, groovy for generating ODI mappings).

● Ops:

Took weekly Ops rotations with colleagues. Used Ops to deepen product knowledge and troubleshoot production issues (e.g., mining metadata tables for root causes) and proposed several improvements to the Ops process.

● Transformation Logic:

Co-authored "Big Book of dbt": the organization's manual of best practices for type casting, deduplication, business-logic encapsulation, test tagging, naming conventions.

Testing

● Load testing:

Revived an underused PL/SQL testing framework: added test templates, expanded coverage beyond file ingestion, and prevented integrity issues before they reached the Data Vault and dimensional model.

- **Unit & regression testing:**

Built an automated regression testing tool in Python with GitHub, CI/CD and Python, adding these technologies to the team's toolstack. The framework itself runs a comprehensive suite of tests, either on source ingestion (source to Data Vault) or presentation (Data Vault to dimensional model) and is still used today, replacing the tedious manual testing cycle we had before. We found many data issues, sped up the testing phase and have gained increased business trust in the data.

Modeling

- **Data Vault & Dimensional:**

Delivered end-to-end solutions from ingestion through Data Vault to dimensional modelling (dimensions/facts, star schema).

Documenting

- **Revamping:**

Found documentation scattered all over the organization and often outdated. Consolidated it in Confluence, rewrote what I could and delegated the rest.

- **Expanding:**

Authored numerous pages to standardise our way of working and help any future new colleagues to onboard faster.

Platform Engineering

Testing

- **Infra Regression Testing:**

Took ownership of a pytest regression testing framework, used to test platform components during an infra release. I added a few tests and refactored the codebase with fixtures, modules and markers - which I particularly enjoyed.

- **Codebase Testing:**

Implemented and owned dbt-bouncer and SQLFluff. Tools for defining and enforcing coding standards in CI/CD.

- **Data quality:**

Helped build a framework that pulls test definitions from Collibra, saves them as dbt tests, deploys to production, runs the test and reports the results.

Tooling

- **dbt:**

Wrote macros and materialisation overrides for organisation-wide use. Performed package upgrades, worked out the kinks and supported data colleagues. Found ways to improve, like reduced parsing time and reduced API calls to Databricks. Advocated and lobbied for dbt-bouncer and SQLFluff. Brought it to maturity from beginning to end: worked with data team colleagues to determine the standards, implemented these standards and enforced them through CI/CD, documented how the tools work and how to configure VS Code for local use.

- **Airflow & AKS:**

Wrote Airflow operators and helped build and expand the orchestration framework: a semantic layer on top of Airflow code. The goal was to prevent data team colleagues writing their own airflow code. Instead they could write a YAML file, using templated airflow tasks. Improved Airflow stability by tuning pod resource allocations, refining queue setup, and configuring Cosmos WATCHER mode to run resource-heavy dbt DAGs more efficiently. Implemented pvc's and configured pvc mounts in airflow helm. Implemented secret scopes and service connections.

- **Databricks:**

Developed a Lakeflow Pipelines framework for SQL Server ingestion. Built an ingestion framework for on-prem Oracle databases to databricks using Spark JDBC. Co-built a trial environment: before release to production, we shallow-clone production data to trial, deploy the release there and run our DAGs. This catches issues before causing incidents on production. Investigated cost spikes and failing SQL queries caused by excessive Unity Catalog API calls.

CI/CD

- **GitHub Actions & release management:**

Implemented PR validations (SQLFluff, dbt-bouncer, YAML schema) and branch protection. Suggested and built a deploy-branch strategy for concurrent deployments to the same test environment. Brought release management to maturity: built a pipeline to generate releases and release notes, implemented automatic labeling of pull requests with dataproduct tags, offering stakeholders insight.

Lead / Team

Way of Working

- **Team Efficiency:**

Drove organisational change by challenging the way of working. In my first team, I reduced unnecessary meetings, introduced Communities of Practice and challenged management's push for an unsuitable framework. In my second team, advocated for better feature refinement, ensuring that stakeholders are named, can be consulted and are presented with the results during development. I also pushed for more demo's, since the team was very poorly T shaped.

Future-proofing

- **Sustainable Solutions:**

Reversed a management-preferred Gherkin/Java decision by delivering a superior Python/GitHub testing framework that was ultimately adopted.

- **Process discipline:**

Enforced disciplined change processes, stopping unplanned "cowboy" changes and ensuring proper consultation and analysis.

Mentoring

● Guiding juniors & newcomers:

Guided two juniors through their onboarding with in-depth weekly demos. Became the go-to person for the subject testing, performance, data vault and release.

EMPLOYMENT

2018 - 2022 - Stock Trader - Self-employed

Independent trading before transition to data engineering. Built analytical discipline and self-directed learning.

Sep 2022 - Nov 2024 - Data Engineer - Argenta, Antwerpen

Oracle tool stack. Built ETL/ELT pipelines, Data Vault & star-schema models, automated testing (Python/GitHub Actions) and Confluence documentation overhaul.

Nov 2024 - Present - Platform Engineer - Argenta, Antwerpen

Azure databricks tool stack. Airflow/AKS, Databricks Lakeflow/JDBC ingestion, dbt & governance, pytest regression testing, GitHub Actions CI/CD & release management. Little bit of terraform.

EDUCATION

Formal Education

Sep 2008 - Jul 2012 - Bachelor of Science in Chemistry - University of Antwerp, Belgium

Sep 2014 - Jul 2018 - Bachelor of Science in Mathematics - University of Antwerp, Belgium

Apr 2022 - Sep 2022 - Data Science Training Program - Cevora, Belgium

Certifications

Jul 2023 [Certified Data Vault 2.0 Practitioner](#) [credential]

Dec 2023 [dbt Fundamentals](#) [credential]

Dec 2023 [Databricks Lakehouse Fundamentals](#) [credential]

Mar 2024 [Astronomer Certification - Apache Airflow Fundamentals](#) [credential]

2026 [Cert Prep: Scrum Master \(LinkedIn Learning\)](#) [credential]

2026 [Scrum: Advanced \(LinkedIn Learning\)](#) [credential]

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